

SKIN DISORDERS

SKIN CONTAINS SOME OF THE FASTEST-MULTIPLYING CELLS IN THE BODY. SEVERAL OF ITS DISORDERS, SUCH AS MOLES, RESULT FROM PROBLEMS IN THIS SELF-RENEWAL SYSTEM. THE SKIN IS ALSO SUSCEPTIBLE TO INJURY, ALLERGIC REACTION IN THE FORM OF RASHES, AND INFECTIONS.

RASHES

Some skin rashes are localized, while others are more widespread. Often, the cause of a rash is not clear. The condition may affect quality of life and require long-term control with self-help measures and medication. Psoriasis is a widespread, patchy rash that flares up at intervals. Episodes may be triggered by infection, injury, stress, or as a side-effect of drug treatment. Eczema is one of the commonest rashes, especially in children. It is

often linked to allergic conditions such as asthma and rhinitis (hay fever). Impetigo is a blistering of the skin caused by bacterial infection, typically through a cut, a cold sore (*Herpes simplex virus*), or scratched, weeping eczema. In vitiligo, the body makes antibodies that attack the skin's pigment-making cells, or melanocytes. It occurs in patchy areas over the body; in about one-third of cases, the pigmentation spontaneously returns.



PSORIASIS

There are several types of psoriasis, mostly characterized by intermittently itchy patches of red, thickened, scaly skin, as dead epidermal cells accumulate. Common sites are the knees, elbows, lower back, scalp, and behind the ears.



ECZEMA

A typical eczema rash is inflamed and itchy, with small fluid-filled blisters or episodes of dry, scaly, thickened, and cracked skin. Common sites are the hands and creased areas of skin, such as the wrists, elbows, and knees. The condition is also known as dermatitis.



IMPETIGO

This bacterial infection is common on the face, most often around the nose and mouth. The skin develops fluid-filled blisters, which burst. This stage is followed by redness, weeping, and crusting that may itch.



VITILIGO

Depigmented patches of skin develop over months or years, especially on the face and hands. The areas are more distinct in people with dark skin. They do not carry any medical risks to health.